Aggressive retaliation likely if US attacks

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【メール原文】

Despite some movement in mediated negotiations, scope for a deal remains limited.||||||||||||||||

Quick take
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Iran likely to retaliate aggressively if US attacks

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Iran is reportedly willing to discuss nuclear issues, but is offering no concessions without the US meeting its demands. Absent a significant US retreat, a deal looks unlikely. Trump is still likely to escalate, though his window for doing so is short. Iran is likely to retaliate aggressively if attacked with strikes on US bases, shipping, and regional energy infrastructure.

What Happened

Iran is reportedly willing to discuss nuclear issues as part of ongoing mediated talks with the US, while Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi has communicated to other countries in the region that Iran will respond aggressively if attacked.

Our Take

Escalation remains likely (60%) as Iran makes only minor concessions. Iran's leaders are reportedly considering a deal whereby UN inspectors are allowed back into the country; however, they continue to insist on up-front concessions from the US. Those concessions include ending the blockade on Iran and unfreezing frozen funds. The latter faces legal constraints in the US and is politically unsupportable absent prior Iranian steps. It is not clear which of Iran's nuclear facilities would be opened to inspection, or when those inspections would take place.

Absent a significant US retreat from its current negotiating position, a limited deal remains unlikely (10%), and US escalation remains probable (see: Escalation still likely despite midterms rout , 4 November 2026). Though Eurasia Group had previously viewed mid-November as the likely window, strikes could come as soon as this weekend, as the US has assets in place to strike targets in Iran with little warning. The political window for US escalation is narrowing because of internal GOP divisions, so a failure to act by mid-November would prompt us to revisit our views.

Iranian retaliation is likely to be aggressive. Iran's rationale for retaliation is to impose costs on the US and the region as a way of deterring further attacks. The Iranians have been signaling publicly and privately that the retaliation will be more aggressive and strike a broader set of targets than in past rounds of fighting.

Iran is likely to strike US bases, as well as shipping and energy targets. US bases in Kuwait, Bahrain, and Jordan are likely to come under the heaviest fire. Iran is also likely to scale up strikes on oil tankers and energy infrastructure in the Persian Gulf and Gulf of Oman to disrupt US escort efforts and put

upward pressure on energy prices. Iran has been threatening strikes on non-energy civilian infrastructure such as undersea cables, desalination plants, power plants, airports, and seaports (see: The US will likely strike Iran in mid-November , 27 October 2026). Iranian leaders have communicated that its retaliation will come “without geographic limit,” suggesting all countries in the region are at risk of attack.

A smaller US attack could trigger more limited retaliation. If the US carries out an attack focused on targets near the Strait of Hormuz, Iran’s retaliation would still be aggressive, though potentially limited to US military assets. If the US strikes only Iran’s nuclear facilities—either the tunnel complex at Isfahan or the facility currently under construction at Pickaxe Mt.—Iran will retaliate aggressively but likely keep its retaliation limited to a single response rather than multiple waves of strikes. Iran will seek to impose costs—there is not scope for a symbolic response, as was the case in June 2025 following the US strikes on Iran’s nuclear facilities—but it will not seek to drag out the conflict.

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